Mohammad Amin Shirazian

(Amin)

Curriculum Vitae

Latest version

Toronto Metropolitan University
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Iranian - Canadian Open Work Permit, exp. 2030

Updated: September 2026

Research Fields

Primary: Macroeconomics, Health Economics
Secondary: Public Economics, Political Economy

References

Keyvan Eslami
Associate Professor (Supervisor)
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Claustre Bajona-Xandri
Associate Professor (Referee)
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Kevin Fawcett
Assistant Professor (Referee)
Department of Economics
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Haomiao Yu
Professor (Teaching Reference)
Department of Economics
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Education

2020–2026 **Ph.D. in Economics**, *Toronto Metropolitan University.*
Full Scholarship; GPA: A+
Thesis: *"Essays on Health Shocks and Other Precautionary Saving Motives"*
Top Second-Year PhD Student, Toronto Metropolitan University (2021)

2018–2020 **M.A. in Economics**, *Tehran Institute for Advanced Studies.*
Full Scholarship; GPA: A
Ranked 68th nationally in Iran's MA Economics entrance examination

2011–2017 **B.A. in Economics**, *University of Tehran.*
Highly competitive, tuition-free admission through Iran's national entrance examination;
GPA: B

Skills

Statistical / data: Stata, R, Python (Selenium, BeautifulSoup) · **Computational:** MATLAB, C++ · **Other:** LaTeX, Git, HTML/CSS · **Languages:** English (fluent), Persian (native)

Job Market Paper

Longevity as a Luxury: Saving Behavior at the Top of the Wealth Distribution latest version

Documenting that both saving and medical spending accelerate at the top, the paper derives a sufficient condition for saving to remain positive at arbitrarily high wealth and shows that the resulting stationary wealth distribution has Pareto tails, the first such result from precautionary saving alone. Calibrated to the data, the mechanism accounts for roughly 11 percent of observed saving in the top wealth decile.

Work in Progress

Means-Tested Insurance and Pareto-Tailed Wealth Distribution In Progress

This paper studies how means-tested healthcare programs affect household wealth accumulation. The usual view emphasizes that households may decumulate wealth to qualify for coverage. We identify a countervailing dynamic force: in each period, households choose whether to reduce their assets and become eligible or to remain ineligible and preserve their wealth. Repeated decisions to remain ineligible can generate sustained wealth accumulation and contribute to wealth concentration at the top of the distribution. Evaluating this eligibility choice empirically requires total medical spending, including the insurance component. Because this measure is unavailable in the Health and Retirement Study, the paper imputes it using the Medical Expenditure Panel Survey (MEPS). It develops conditions for consistency of the imputation and of OLS estimates using the imputed dependent variable. A stylized model shows how an asset threshold for means-tested insurance can generate strategic asset decumulation, linking insurance eligibility to household saving behavior.

Online Innovation, Market Entry and Competition in Remote Indigenous Communities In Progress

With Nicholas Li and Yasir Mudathir.

Health Production Function and Longevity In Progress

This project studies the health production function by identifying which health products and medical technologies improve survival, how effectively private treatment supplements available care, and how rapidly returns to additional medical spending diminish. It examines the wealth threshold at which households begin to demand these products and the characteristics beyond wealth that shape the demand for longevity, while addressing the two-way relationship between longevity preferences and wealth accumulation.

Optimal Insurance Against Mortality Shocks In Progress

This project extends the current framework to a general-equilibrium model with bequest motives and family dynamics. The model captures how households share health risks, provide informal care, transfer wealth across generations, and save for medical needs and bequests. It evaluates how much of saving across the wealth distribution these motives explain, whether household choices under the existing healthcare and insurance system are efficient, and when incomplete insurance markets create a rationale for government intervention.

Gender and Longevity: A Retirement Saving Puzzle MA Thesis

This paper presents an explanation to the excess sensitivity of consumption to the drop in income around retirement, known as the "retirement saving puzzle." We confirm this empirical puzzle also prevails among Iranian families. That is, an unpredicted drop occurs in households' non-durable expenditures around the age of 65, which cannot be resolved even by decomposing household heads according to their labor status. Then, by taking into account the diversity in the gender composition of cohorts, we demonstrate that the gap between predicted and actual non-durable expenditures is no longer apparent.

Teaching & Work Experience

Teaching

Summer 2024 – Present

Contract Lecturer, Department of Economics, Toronto Metropolitan University.

Fall 2026: CECN230 – *Mathematics for Economics* (enrollment TBD)
Summer 2026: CECN600 – *Intermediate Macroeconomics II* (20 students)
Spring 2026: CECN603 – *Economic Issues in Globalization* (53 students)
Winter 2026: CECN301 – *Intermediate Macroeconomics I* (87 students)
Fall 2025: CECN301 – *Intermediate Macroeconomics I* (38 students)
Summer 2025: CECN603 – *Economic Issues in Globalization* (44 students)
Winter 2025: CECN301 – *Intermediate Macroeconomics I* (61 students)
Summer 2024: CECN204 – *Introductory Macroeconomics* (59 students)

Graduate Assistant

2018 – Fall 2026

Teaching Assistant

Department of Economics, Toronto Metropolitan University.
Taught *Adv. Macroeconomics I*, *Mathematical Economics*, *Advanced Microeconomics II*; led PhD tutorials

Tehran Institute for Advanced Studies / Khatam University. Taught *Advanced Macroeconomics*, *Advanced Financial Economics*; led MA tutorials

Graduate Assistant Recognition Award, Toronto Metropolitan University (2022–2023)

2022–2024

Research Assistant

Department of Economics, Toronto Metropolitan University
Prof. Keyvan Eslami – *Imputing Total Medical Spending*: Combined HRS and MEPS data to impute total medical spending for econometric analysis.

Department of Economics, University of Toronto
Prof. Nicholas Li – *Nutrition North Price Data*: Built a web-scraping workflow to collect and organize prices from Nutrition North program providers' websites.

Tehran Institute for Advanced Studies, Tehran, Iran
Prof. Farshad Hagh-Panah – *Household Income and Expenditure Survey Database*: Collected, streamlined, and cleaned HIES data and constructed a database of households classified by the gender of the household head.

Union Experience

2021–2023

Economics Graduate Students Association, Toronto Metropolitan University
President (2021–2022); *VP Communication* (2022–2023)
Student-association leadership focused on planning events, coordinating funding with the student union and faculty, and managing teams, invitations, and logistics.

2021–2022

Union Governance – Faculty of Arts Director, Toronto Metropolitan Graduate Students' Union (TMGSU)
Represented the Faculty of Arts on the union board; reviewed bylaws, attended governance meetings, helped develop the newly established union's structure, and contributed to funding decisions for health insurance and graduate-student travel.